Panel

Wood, Ivory

W: 58 cm; H: 58 cm

Inv. no. 11724





A square wooden panel featuring an intricate strapwork pattern of six-pointed stars, hexagons, and smaller irregular polygons executed through interlocking joinery with wood and ivory pieces. The central six-pointed star and six surrounding hexagons are all composed of kaleidoscopic zarnashan patterns of coloured woods, (stained) ivory, and mother-of-pearl. The reverse of the panel reveals the dense and careful joinery required to achieve the complex surface geometry. Likely dated to the Mamluk period, the panel appears to have been a highly accomplished component of a larger furnishing such as a cupboard or chair, later removed from its original context and appreciated as an independent artwork. A modern metal fixture on the reverse, used for hanging, indicates its subsequent display as an objet d'art during the ownership of Prince Kamal al-Din Hussein (1874-1932).

Nadim Foundation ©® 2026